

Inkscape (Utilities, 37 MB)

Inkscape is an open source vector graphics editor that is similar to Illustrator, CorelDraw or Xara X. It uses the W3C standard scalable vector graphics (SVG) file format. The latest version of the software is 0.47, which was released on November 24, 2009. The software is written in C++ using GTK+ and is licenced under GNU GPL. It is compatible with XML, SVG and CSS standards. Certain features that Inkscape offers are object creation, object manipulation, styling objects, operations on path, text manipulation, rendering and many others. Using the object creation tool box you can create objects such as rectangle, polygon, circle, etc. You can also create 3D images such as 3D boxes using 3D tool box.

The object manipulation tool lets you move, rotate, scale and skew objects. You can also copy and paste objects on the clipboard. There are styling objects in Inkscape, which lets you fill colours into the created objects. Text rendering in Inkscape is based on the Pango library, which supports complex scripts including Hebrew, Arabic, Thai, Tibetan, etc. The software runs on Linux, FreeBSD, Mac OS X and Microsoft Windows. For more information visit <http://www.inkscape.org/>

**Pencil** (Utilities, 5.29 MB)

'Pencil Planner' by Patrick Corrieri is the original source of Pencil, which is a free and open source software. Its latest version available is 0.4.4b. It is an animation and drawing software that lets you create both traditional hand-drawn



animations and vector graphics. The software has been created to enable anyone to make 2D animation. The main website of the software contains a wiki for developers, where you can find how to join the Pencil group, how to get started, documentation on the existing code and a list of tasks that needs to be addressed by the developers. The software can be run on Windows, Mac OS and Linux. For more information visit <http://www.pencil-animation.org/>

Kingsoft 2009 (Utilities, 48.4 MB)

Kingsoft 2009 has been created by Great Worth International Limited. This is basically a cost-effective office suite that offers all the features of a normal office suite. But interestingly, it looks just like Microsoft Office.

In other words, you may consider it as a replacement for Microsoft Office. It comes with a writer, a spreadsheet and a presentation software. One

of the advantages of this software is that users who have used Microsoft Office at any point of time can easily operate it. Moreover, it supports cross-platforms, hence supports the Microsoft Office files too. It also incorporates a PDF converter. The trial version of this software is available for 100 days. The minimum system requirement for the software is Windows 2000 or higher, 266MHz CPU or higher, 64MB RAM, 80MB hard disk space and IE6.0 or higher. For more information visit <http://www.ksoffice.net/>

**Thunderbird** (Utilities, 8.57 MB)

Mozilla Thunderbird, a free and open source software that can be used for email and news transactions, has been developed by Mozilla Foundation. It is a great tool to manage your emails, as it offers a good number of useful features. Its latest version has been released on December 8, 2009. The entire code of this software is written in C++ and there are a few additions in its new version. These new features include better search options and email archiving; you can also open your mails in tabs just the way you open new tabs in Mozilla Firefox.

It is a cross-platform software, hence runs on Windows, Linux, Mac and others. For more information visit <http://www.mozillamessaging.com/en-US/thunderbird/>

